## What Worked

- Students clearly understood the structure and expectations of the exam.
- Many responses demonstrated well-developed writing and analytical skills.

## What Needs Improvement

- Some students forgot to clearly label their chosen text (Section A) or Framework of Ideas (Section B).
- Some responses misinterpreted the prompt or overlooked key words in the question.

## Practical Tips

- Label your work clearly. Always begin with:

  Section A: 'Text: Macbeth | Prompt: 'Ambition leads to downfall. Do you agree?'"

  Section B: 'Title: Resist and Persist | Framework: Protest"
- Build your vocabulary. Familiarise yourself with words like inescapable, perceptions, central concern, implication, etc.
- Select the best-fit prompt. Choose the one that allows you to demonstrate your strongest understanding, not just the one that sounds easiest.

Your task: Write a structured essay in response to one of two prompts for your studied text.

## What Worked

- High-scoring responses interpreted the topic with nuance and clarity.
- Students demonstrated a strong understanding of authorial intent.
- Responses were well structured and supported with relevant textual evidence.

## What Needs Improvement

- Some students only responded to part of the question (e.g. discussing 'youth" but not 'infatuation with youth").
- Others summarised the plot or characters instead of analysing the text's ideas and values.

## Practical Tips

Section A - Effective vs Ineffective Approaches

| Effective Approach | Ineffective Approach |
|---|---|
| Interpreting all keywords in the topic | Ignoring modifiers (e.g. “unrelenting cruelty” vs “cruelty”) |
| Using a clear “what/how/why” structure | Listing unrelated examples |
| Connecting ideas across paragraphs | Treating each paragraph as a standalone point |
| Focusing on how the author constructs meaning | Just retelling the storyline |

’ **Tip:** Write practice introductions where you break down the prompt. Ask:

- What is the main idea or concept?
- Are there two ideas in relationship?
- What are the implications or assumptions?

Your task: Create an original piece of writing that responds to a title and stimulus, grounded in one of the four Frameworks of Ideas.

## What Worked

- High-scoring pieces treated the title and stimulus as central, not secondary.
- Strong voice, clear purpose, and tailored language made the writing stand out.
- Responses showed thoughtful exploration of ideas relevant to the Framework.

## What Needs Improvement

- Some students ignored or misunderstood the Framework (e.g. writing about sports under the Protest framework).
- Others forced pre-prepared stories to fit the title.
- Lack of planning resulted in unstructured or unfocused pieces.

## Practical Strategies

### Planning Method

- Framework: Personal Journeys
- Title: Finding My Way
- Stimulus: Butterfly emerging from a cocoon
- Purpose: Reflective
- Audience: Teenagers navigating cultural identity
- Text Type: Memoir

### Tips for Strong Writing

- Use recurring imagery or motifs to strengthen cohesion.
- Match tone to purpose: persuasive, reflective, emotive, or narrative.
- End with intention: resolution, reflection, or call to action.

Your task: Analyse how a written and visual text positions its audience.

## What Worked

- Identifying the author's contention and target audience.
- Analysing tone, persuasive language, structure, and visuals.
- Exploring how language is used to shape reader response.

## What Needs Improvement

- Avoid retelling the article.
- Go beyond spotting techniques; explain their effect and purpose.

## Practical Strategies

Section B: Effective Strategies and Examples

| Strategy | Example |
| --- | --- |
| Identify contention and purpose | 'The writer argues that vaping is a growing public health crisis and seeks to alarm parents." |

| Strategy | Example |
| --- | --- |
| Link language to effect | 'By using the phrase 'a ticking time bomb', the writer creates a sense of urgency and panic." |
| Analyse visuals | 'The image of a distressed child reinforces the emotional appeal used in the article's opening." |
| Use precise metalanguage | Appeal to fear, inclusive language, repetition, expert opinion, etc. |

- Have I practised responding to a range of prompts and titles?
- Do I clearly understand my Frameworks of Ideas?
- Can I write for a clear audience and purpose?
- Have I reviewed unfamiliar vocabulary and metalanguage?
- Can I plan and write all three sections under timed conditions?

The 2027 exam will reward students who think deeply, write purposefully, and tailor their writing to the demands of the task. Whether you're analysing a text, creating your own piece, or evaluating argument and language, success lies in showing insight, clarity, and control.

Strong writing does not come from memorisation—it comes from understanding. Prepare thoughtfully, practise deliberately, and revise reflectively.